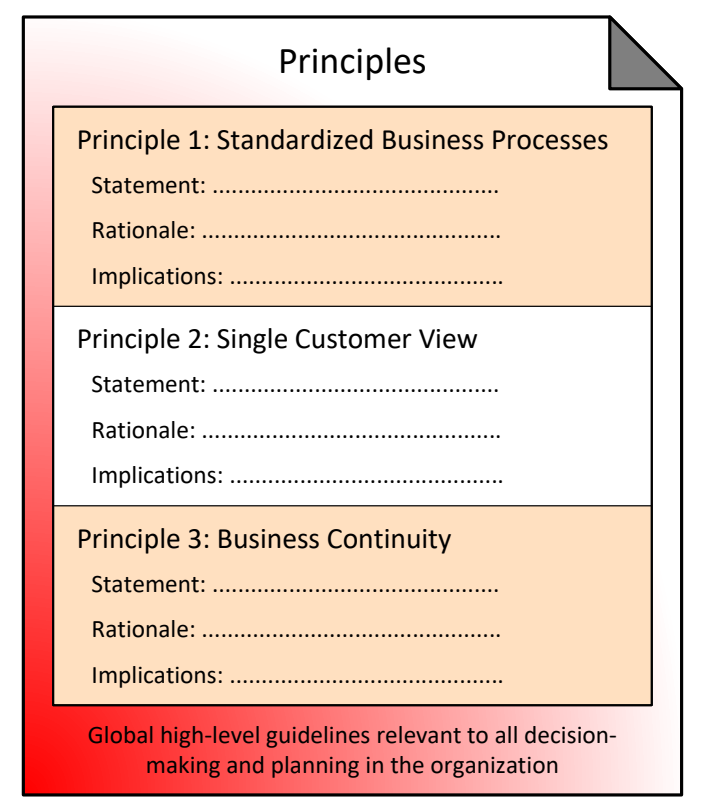
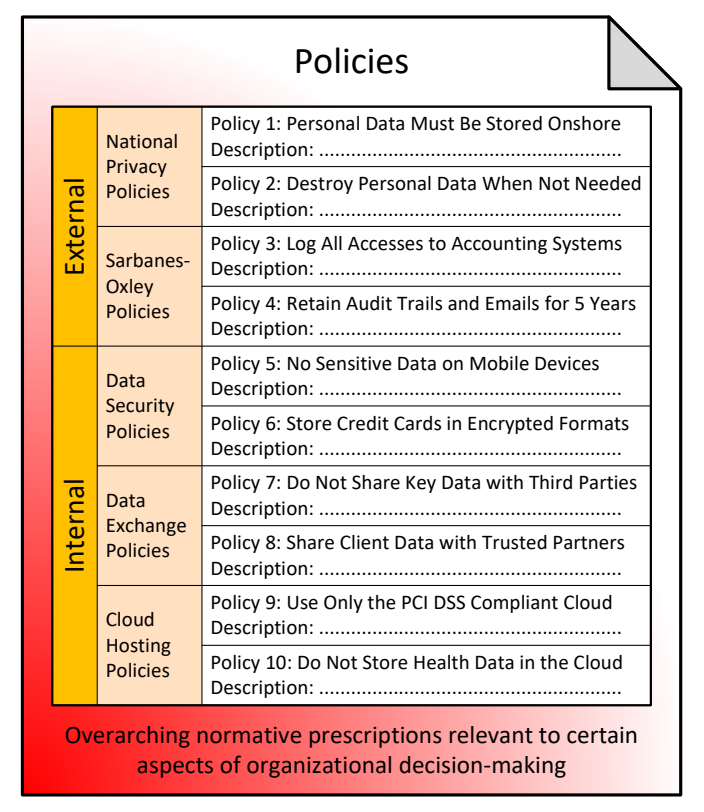
Enterprise Architecture Artifacts on a Page

(An aggregated one-page view of popular EA artifacts used in organizations with their most essential properties)


Principle 1: Standardized Business Processes
Statement:
Rationale:
Implications:
Principle 2: Single Customer View
Principle 3: Business Continuity

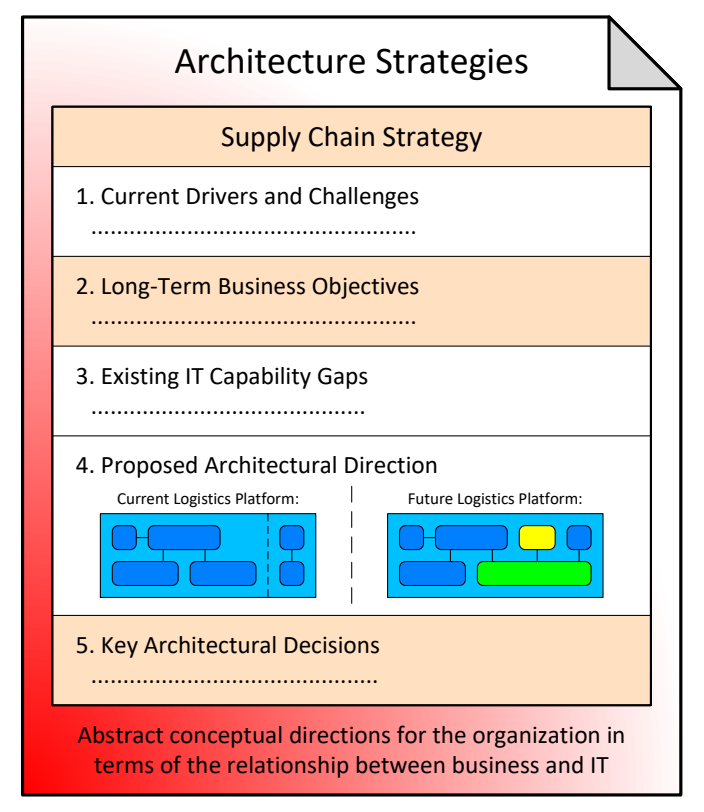
Principles

Global high-level guidelines relevant to all decision-making and planning in the organization


External
Internal
National Privacy Policies
Sarbanes-Oxley Policies
Data Security Policies
Data Exchange Policies
Cloud Hosting Policies
Policy 1: Personal Data Must Be Stored Onshore
Policy 2: Destroy Personal Data When Not Needed
Policy 3: Log All Accesses to Accounting Systems
Policy 4: Retain Audit Trails and Emails for 5 Years
Policy 5: No Sensitive Data on Mobile Devices
Policy 6: Store Credit Cards in Encrypted Formats
Policy 7: Do Not Share Key Data with Third Parties
Policy 8: Share Client Data with Trusted Partners
Policy 9: Use Only the PCI DSS Compliant Cloud
Policy 10: Do Not Store Health Data in the Cloud

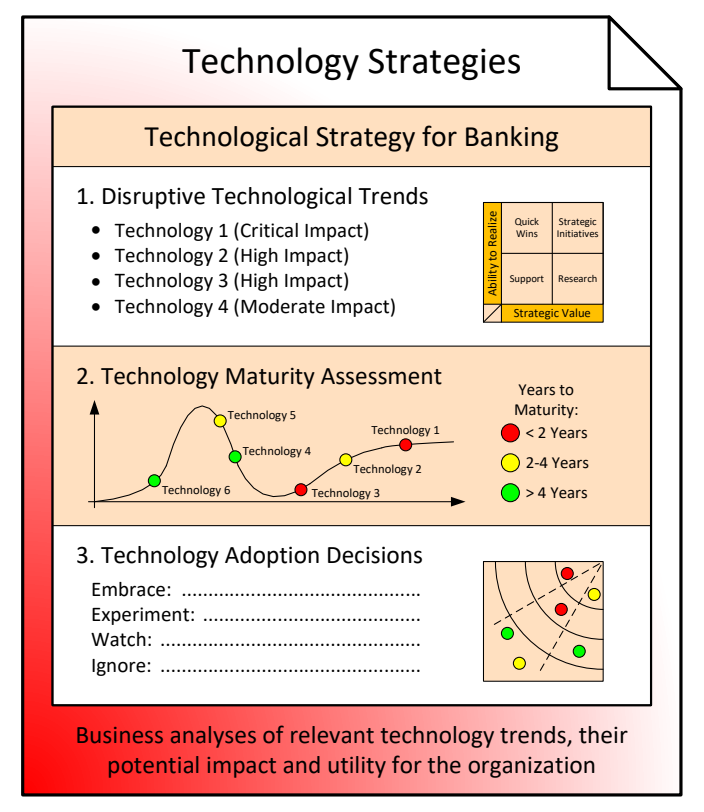
Policies

Overarching normative prescriptions relevant to certain aspects of organizational decision-making


Supply Chain Strategy
1. Current Drivers and Challenges
2. Long-Term Business Objectives
3. Existing IT Capability Gaps
4. Proposed Architectural Direction
Current Logistics Platform:
Future Logistics Platform:
5. Key Architectural Decisions

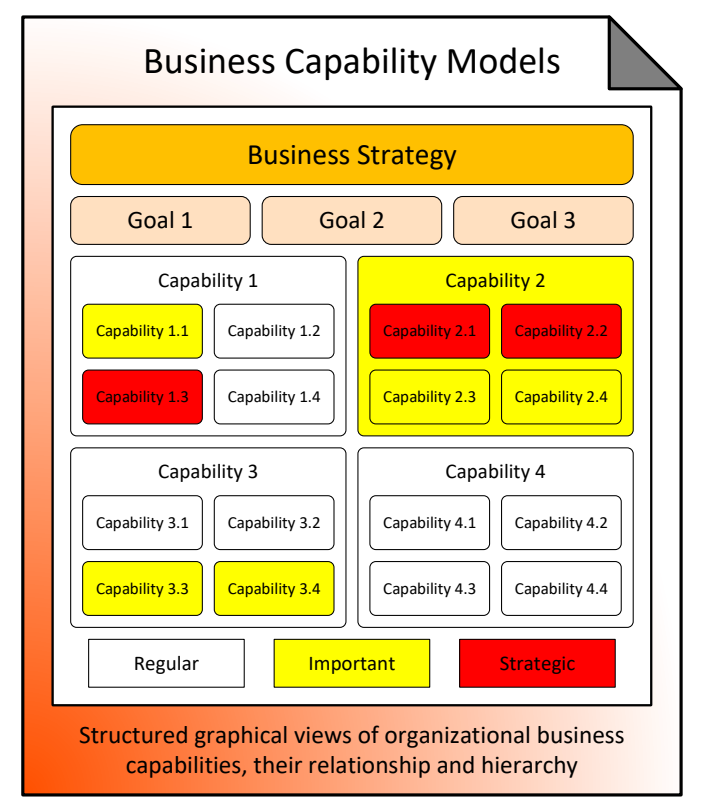
Architecture Strategies

Abstract conceptual directions for the organization in terms of the relationship between business and IT


Technological Strategy for Banking
1. Disruptive Technological Trends
Technology 1 (Critical Impact)
Technology 2 (High Impact)
Technology 3 (High Impact)
Technology 4 (Moderate Impact)
2. Technology Maturity Assessment
Years to Maturity:
< 2 Years
2-4 Years
> 4 Years
3. Technology Adoption Decisions
Embrace:
Experiment:
Watch:
Ignore:

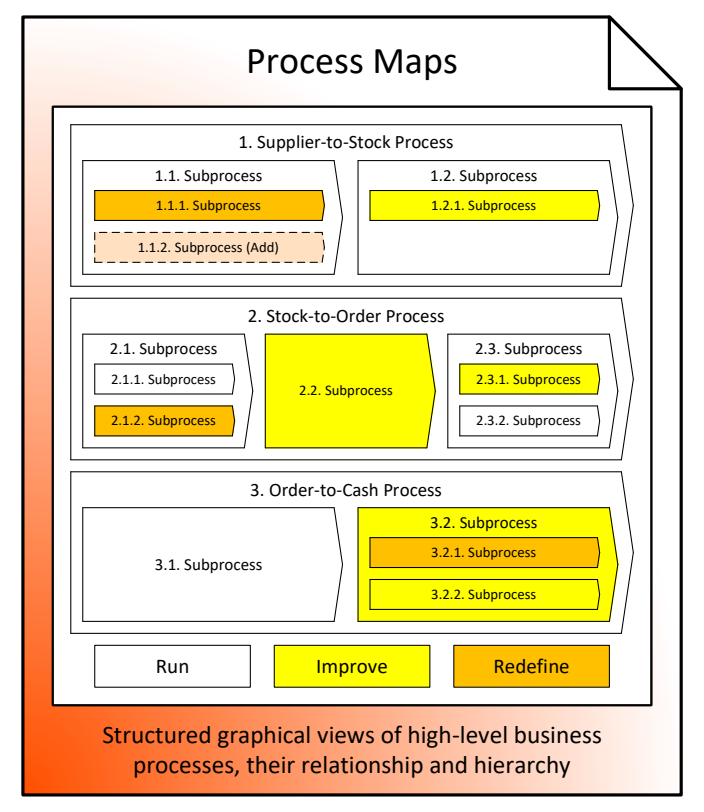
Technology Strategies

Business analyses of relevant technology trends, their potential impact and utility for the organization



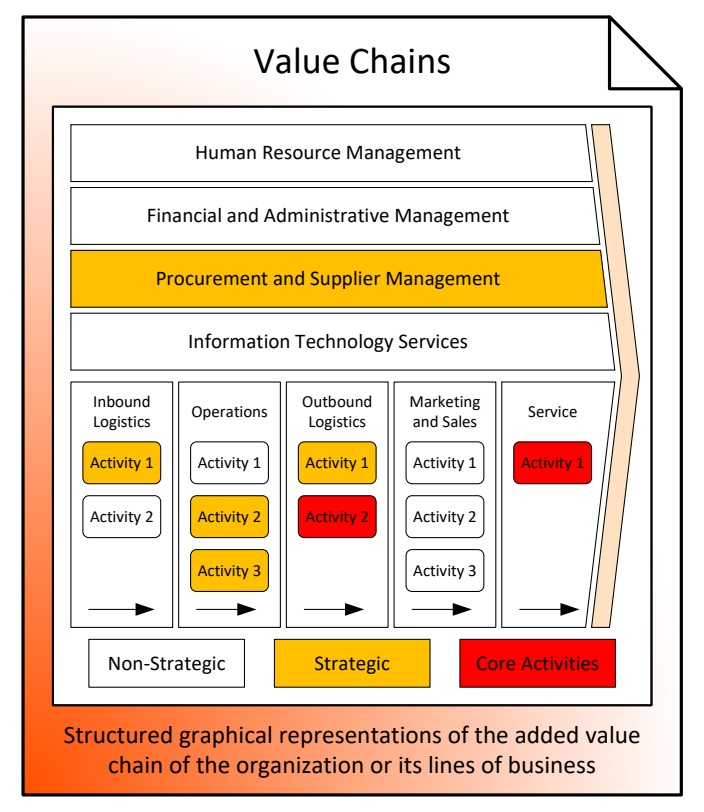
Business Capability Models

Structured graphical views of organizational business capabilities, their relationship and hierarchy



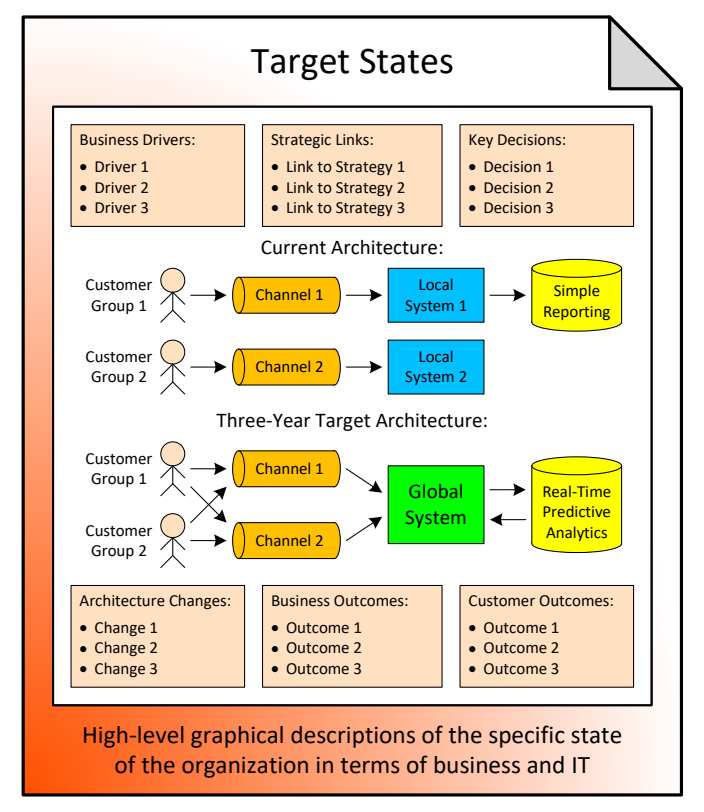
Process Maps

Structured graphical views of high-level business processes, their relationship and hierarchy


Human Resource Management
Financial and Administrative Management
Procurement and Supplier Management
Information Technology Services
Inbound Logistics
Operations
Outbound Logistics
Marketing and Sales
Service
Non-Strategic
Strategic
Core Activities

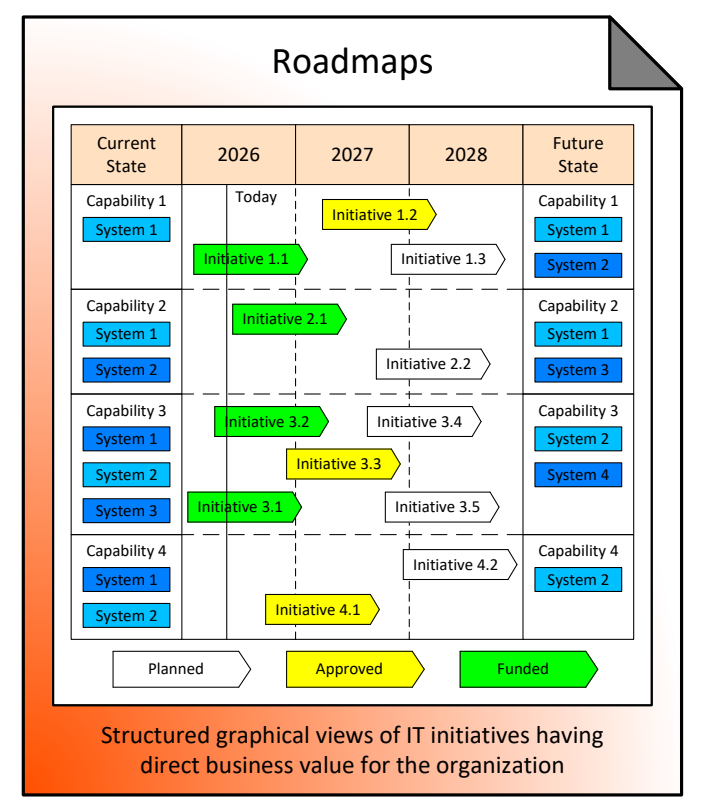
Value Chains

Structured graphical representations of the added value chain of the organization or its lines of business



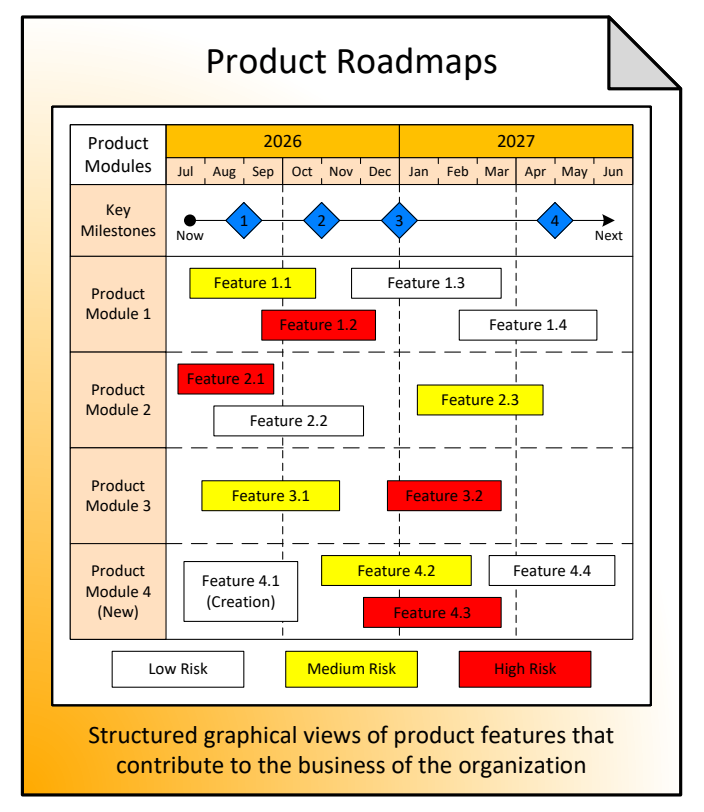
Target States

High-level graphical descriptions of the specific state of the organization in terms of business and IT



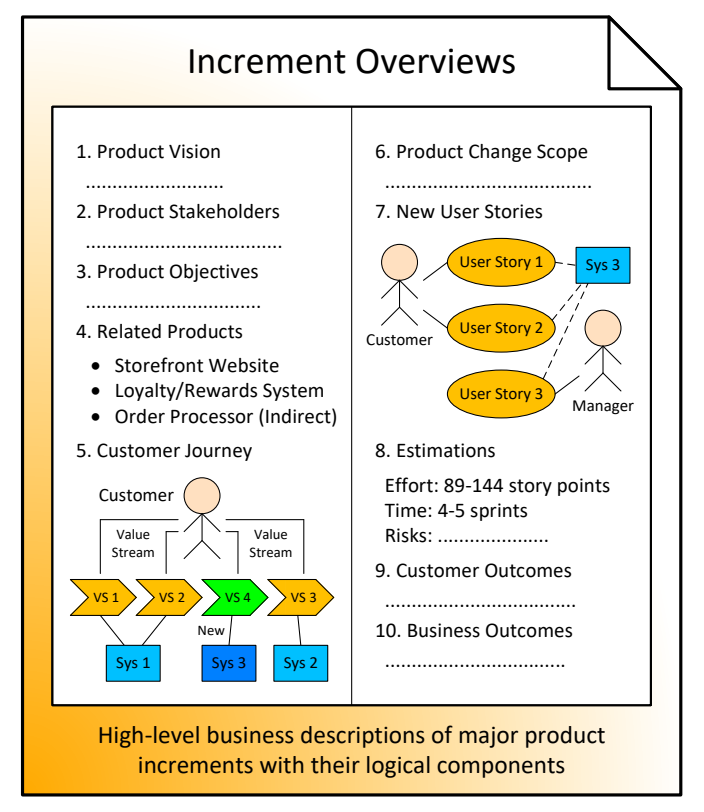
Roadmaps

Structured graphical views of IT initiatives having direct business value for the organization



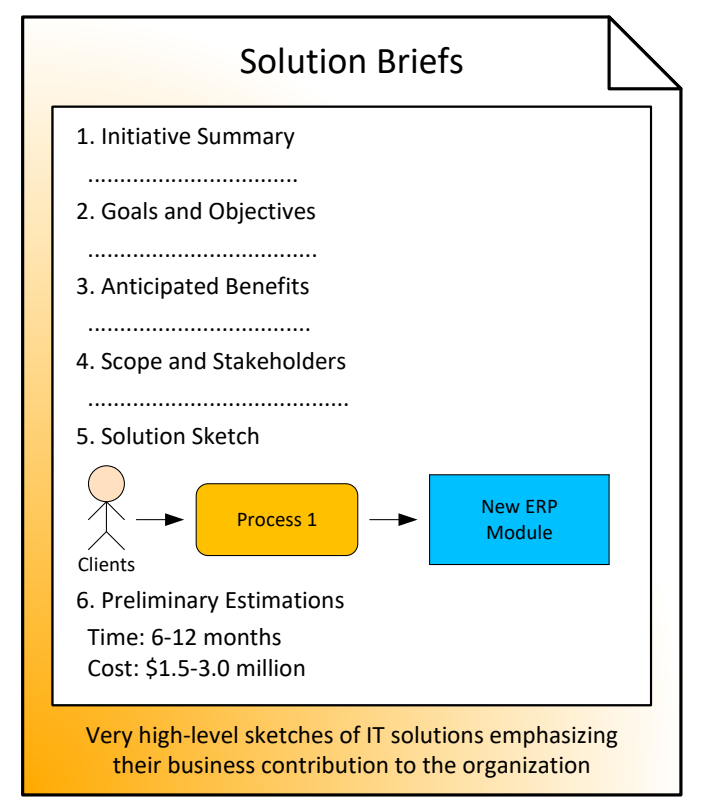
Product Roadmaps

Structured graphical views of product features that contribute to the business of the organization



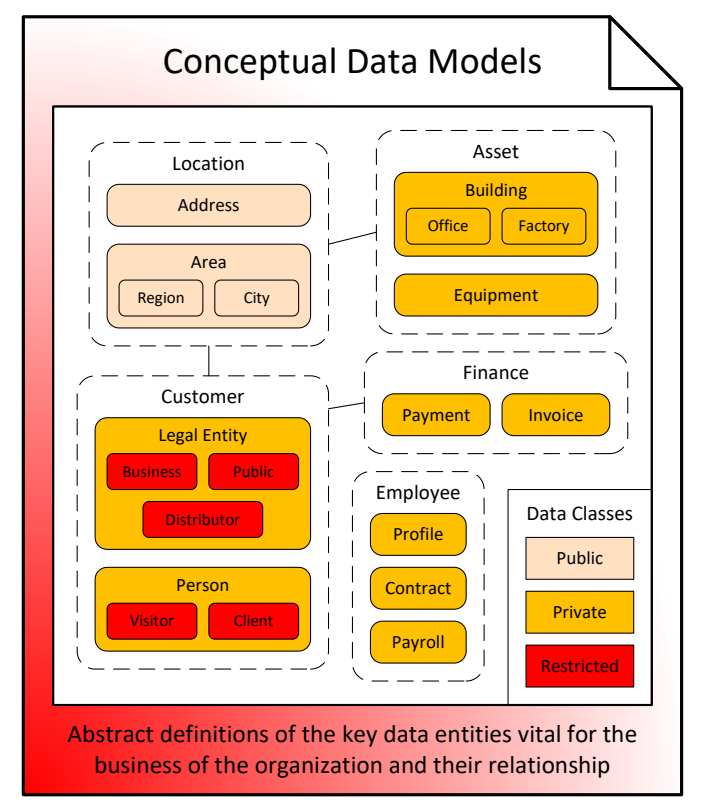
Increment Overviews

High-level business descriptions of major product increments with their logical components



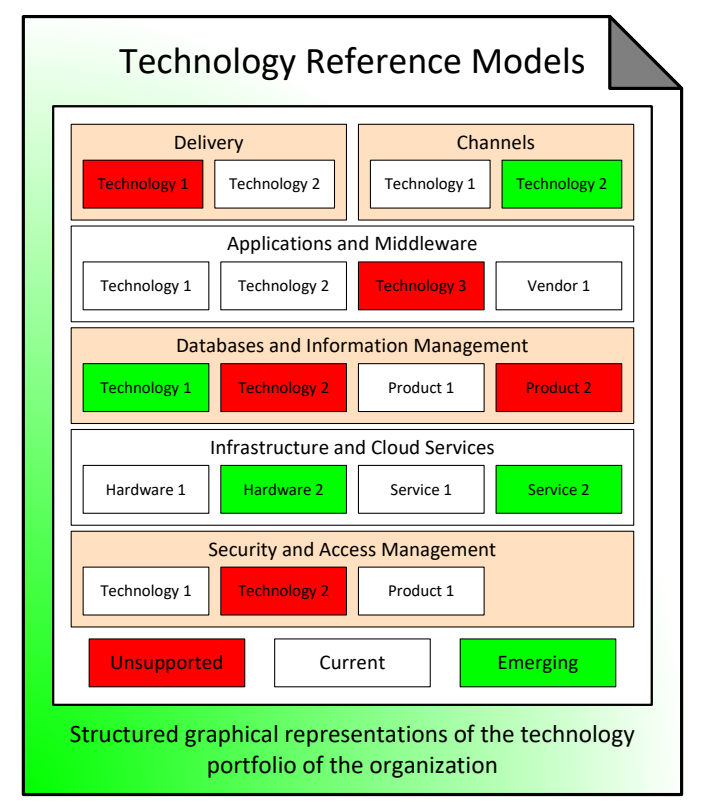
Solution Briefs

Very high-level sketches of IT solutions emphasizing their business contribution to the organization



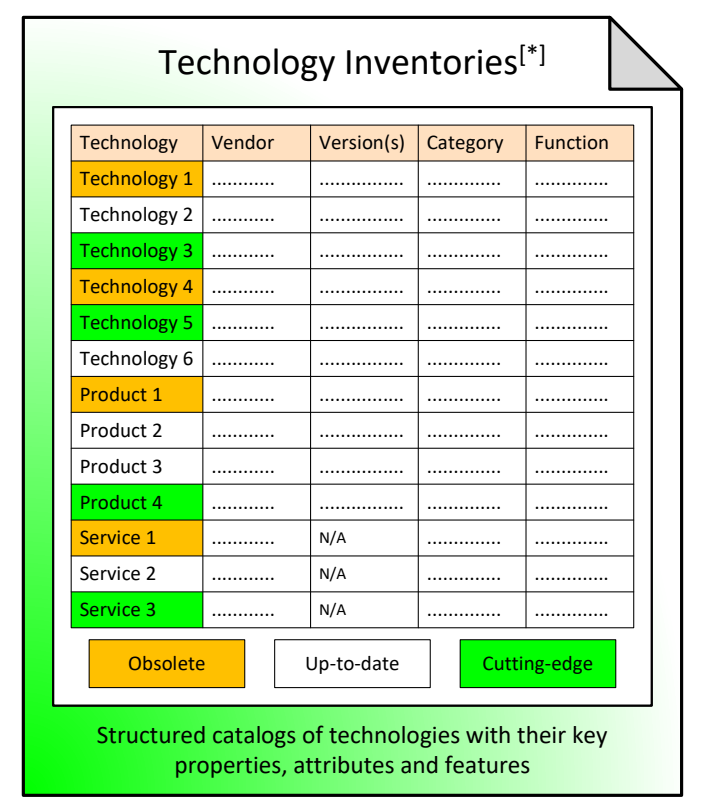
Conceptual Data Models

Abstract definitions of the key data entities vital for the business of the organization and their relationship


Delivery
Channels
Applications and Middleware
Databases and Information Management
Infrastructure and Cloud Services
Security and Access Management
Unsupported
Current
Emerging

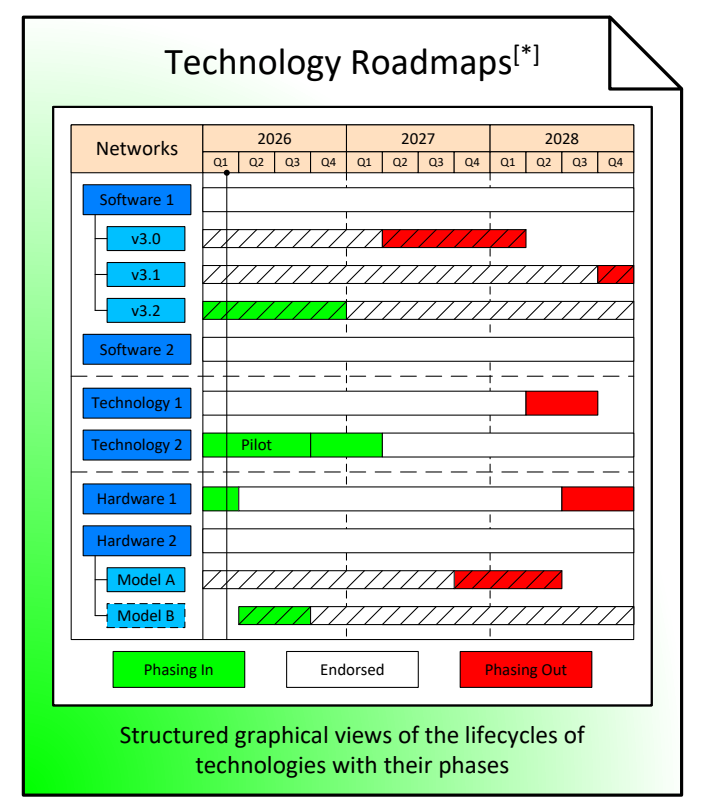
Technology Reference Models

Structured graphical representations of the technology portfolio of the organization



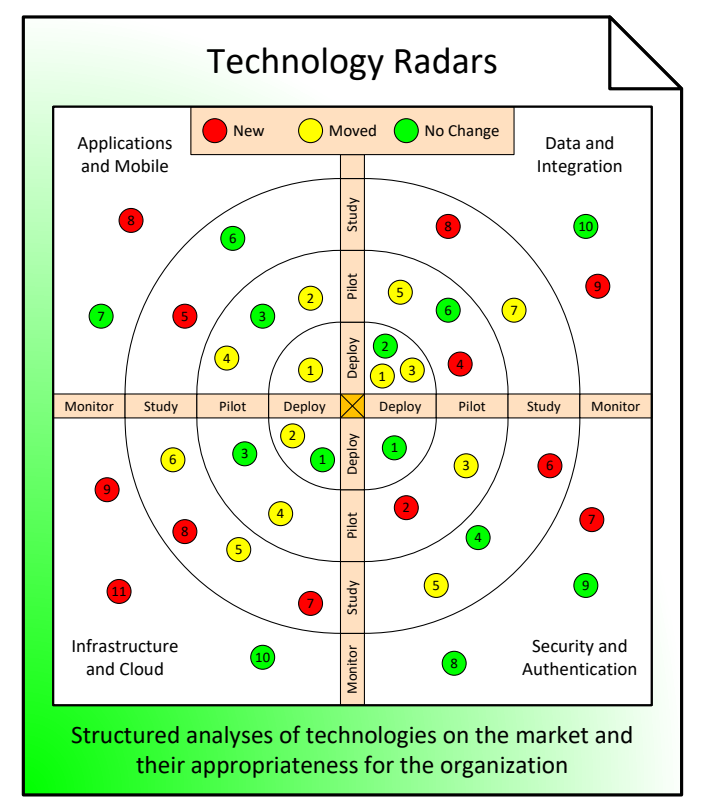
Technology Inventories[*]

Structured catalogs of technologies with their key properties, attributes and features



Technology Roadmaps[*]

Structured graphical views of the lifecycles of technologies with their phases



Technology Radars

Structured analyses of technologies on the market and their appropriateness for the organization

What EA Artifacts Describe?

Generic ← → Specific

Rules	Structures	Solutions/Products

How EA Artifacts Describe?

Business ↑ Business-Focused

IT-Focused ↓ IT

Considerations

Content: Global conceptual rules and fundamental considerations important for business and relevant to IT

Focus: Do not refer to specific points in time or focus on the long-term future

Format: Expressed in simple intuitive formats, often as brief written statements, sometimes with inelaborate visualizations

Meaning: Decisions on how the organization needs to work or what it wants to achieve from a business and IT perspective

Usage: Developed collaboratively by business leaders and Enterprise Architects as part of Strategic Planning and then used to influence all architectural decisions (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Established once and then updated according to the ongoing changes in the business environment

Role: Overarching organizational context for information systems planning

Purpose: Help achieve the agreement on basic principles, values, directions and aims

Benefits: Improved overall consistency between business and IT

Visions

Content: High-level conceptual descriptions of the organization from a business perspective

Focus: Often focus on the long-term future up to 3–5 years ahead

Format: Expressed in brief informal formats, often as large but simple one-page diagrams

Meaning: Decisions on what IT should provide to the organization in the long run

Usage: Developed collaboratively by business leaders and Enterprise Architects as part of Strategic Planning and then used to guide IT investments, identify, prioritize and launch new IT initiatives (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Created once and then updated according to the ongoing changes in strategic business priorities

Role: Shared views of the organization and its future agreed by business and IT

Purpose: Help achieve the alignment between IT investments and long-term business outcomes

Benefits: Improved strategic alignment and effectiveness of IT investments

Outlines

Solutions
(Project Mode)

Content: High-level descriptions of separate IT solutions from a business point of view

Focus: Usually focus on the mid-term future up to 1–2 years ahead

Format: Expressed as a mix of textual descriptions and simple diagrams

Meaning: Decisions on how approximately specific IT solutions should be implemented

Usage: Developed collaboratively by business managers and Solution Architects during the initiation phase of Project Implementation and then used to evaluate, approve and fund specific IT solutions (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Produced at the early stages of IT projects to support decision-making and then archived, but can be used later for post-implementation benefit review

Role: Benefit, time and price tags for proposed IT solutions

Purpose: Help estimate the overall business impact and value of proposed IT solutions

Benefits: Improved efficiency and ROI of IT investments

Products
(Product Mode)

Content: High-level descriptions of separate IT products from a business point of view

Focus: Usually focus on the mid-term future up to 1–2 years ahead

Format: Expressed as a mix of textual descriptions and simple diagrams

Meaning: Decisions on what product increments should be implemented next

Usage: Developed collaboratively by business managers and Product Architects in the exploration stream of Product Implementation and then used to evaluate, approve and fund specific product increments (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Either produced once and updated according to the ongoing changes in product priorities, or produced to support decision-making and then archived

Role: Benefit, time and effort tags for proposed product increments

Purpose: Help estimate the overall business impact and value of proposed product increments

Benefits: Improved efficiency and ROI of IT investments

Language: Technology-neutral business language

Domains: The business domain and other relevant domains at a high level

Format: Brief, intuitive, largely informal and include only the most essential information

Stakeholders: Business leaders and architects

Role: Communication interfaces between business and IT

Purpose: Help business leaders manage IT for value

Benefits: Improved business and IT alignment

Standards

Content: Global technical rules, norms, patterns and best practices relevant to information systems

Focus: Do not refer to specific points in time or focus on the current state

Format: Can be expressed in various formats, often using strict notations

Meaning: Decisions on how all IT systems should be constructed and some facts on the current approaches and technologies

Usage: Developed collaboratively by Enterprise Architects and technical subject-matter experts as part of Technology Optimization and used to shape the architectures of all IT initiatives (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Established on an as-needed basis and updated according to the ongoing technology progress

Role: Proven reusable means for IT system implementation

Purpose: Help achieve technical consistency, technological homogeneity and regulatory compliance

Benefits: Faster initiative implementation, reduced costs, risks and complexity

Landscapes

Content: High-level technical descriptions of the organizational IT landscape

Focus: Focus mainly on the current state, sometimes looking into the future

Format: Expressed in strict formats, often as complex one-page diagrams using formal modeling notations, e.g. ArchiMate

Meaning: Facts on the current IT landscape and some decisions on its future evolution

Usage: Developed and maintained by Enterprise Architects as part of Technology Optimization and used to rationalize the IT landscape, manage the lifecycle of IT assets and plan new IT initiatives (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Created on an as-needed basis and updated according to the ongoing evolution of the IT landscape

Role: Knowledge base of reference materials on the corporate IT landscape

Purpose: Help understand, analyze and modify the structure of the IT landscape

Benefits: Increased reuse and agility, reduced duplication and legacy

Designs

Solutions
(Project Mode)

Content: Detailed technical and functional descriptions of separate IT systems with their internal structure

Focus: Normally focus on the short-term future up to one year ahead

Format: Expressed as a mix of text, tables and complex diagrams, can be voluminous and often use formal modeling notations, e.g. UML

Meaning: Decisions on how exactly specific IT systems should be constructed

Usage: Developed collaboratively by Solution Architects, project teams and business representatives during the realization phase of Project Implementation and then used by project teams to deliver IT systems (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Produced at the later stages of IT projects to support delivery efforts and then archived, but can be used later as current-state reference materials

Role: Communication interfaces between Solution Architects and project teams

Purpose: Help build approved IT systems according to business and architectural requirements

Benefits: Improved quality and reduced risks of project delivery

Products
(Product Mode)

Content: Detailed technical and functional descriptions of separate IT products or their features

Focus: Focus on the current state or the immediate future up to a few months ahead

Format: Expressed as a mix of text, tables and diagrams and often use formal modeling notations, e.g. C4 Model

Meaning: Facts on the current product structure and decisions on its future evolution

Usage: Developed and maintained collaboratively by Product Architects and product teams in the realization stream of Product Implementation and used by product teams to deliver product features (see *Enterprise Architecture Practice on a Page*)

Lifecycle: Either produced once and updated according to the ongoing evolution of IT products, or produced to support delivery efforts and then archived

Role: Communication interfaces between Product Architects and product teams

Purpose: Help build new product features while preserving overall architectural consistency

Benefits: Reduced technical debt and improved quality of feature delivery

Language: Technical IT-specific language

Domains: Various technical domains and sometimes the business domain

Format: Can be voluminous, formal, use strict notations and include comprehensive details

Stakeholders: Architects and other IT professionals

Role: Internal IT tools invisible to business

Purpose: Help architects organize IT properly

Benefits: Improved intrinsic IT efficiency

Describe: Universal rules defining the organization or its divisions

Scope: Very broad, often relate to the entire organization

Format: Often textual

Question: How do we work or want to work?

Lifecycle: Permanent, created once and then periodically updated

Role: Basis for all other architectural decisions

Purpose: Help achieve consistency and homogeneity of all planning decisions

Describe: High-level structures of the organization or its parts

Scope: Broad, often cover large areas of the organization

Format: Usually graphical

Question: What approximately do we have or want to have?

Lifecycle: Permanent, created once and then continuously updated

Role: High-level "maps" facilitating decision-making

Purpose: Help understand what changes are desirable and how to implement them

Describe: Specific IT solutions in the organizational context

Scope: Narrow, limited to separate IT solutions or systems

Format: Mix of textual and graphical

Question: What exactly are we going to change right now?

Lifecycle: Temporary, created for specific purposes within IT projects but then discarded

Role: Tactical plans of the organization

Purpose: Help implement separate landscape changes

Describe: Specific IT products in the organizational context

Scope: Narrow, limited to separate IT products or features

Format: Mix of textual and graphical

Question: What exactly do we have or want to have now?

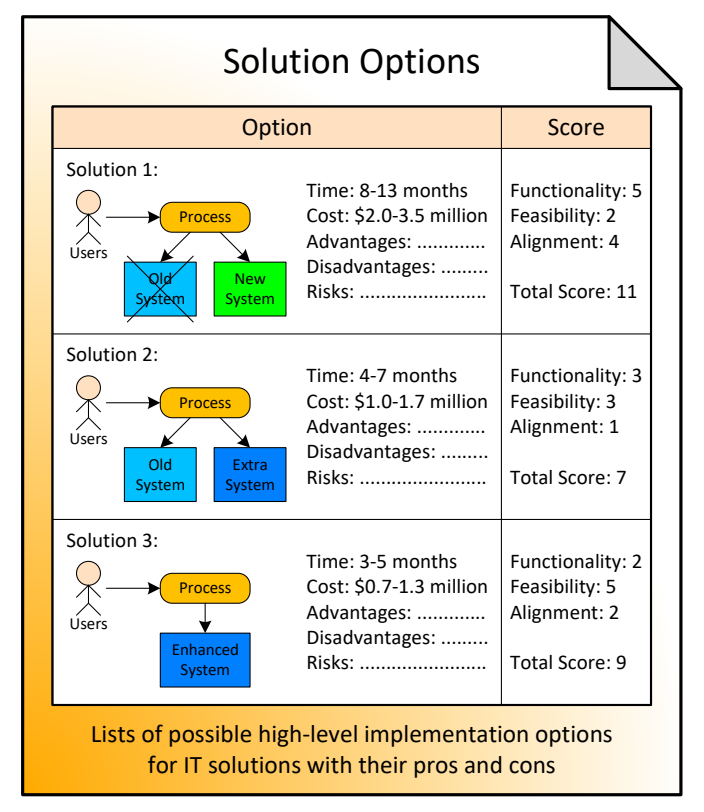
Lifecycle: Permanent or temporary, updated with IT products or discarded after usage

Role: Working materials of IT products

Purpose: Help develop individual IT products sustainably

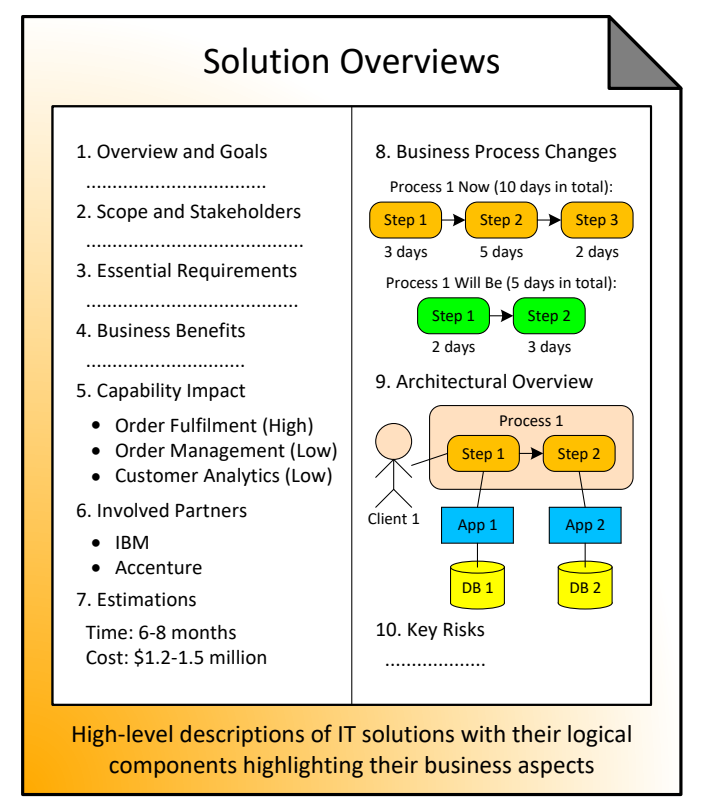
Products

Solutions



Solution Options

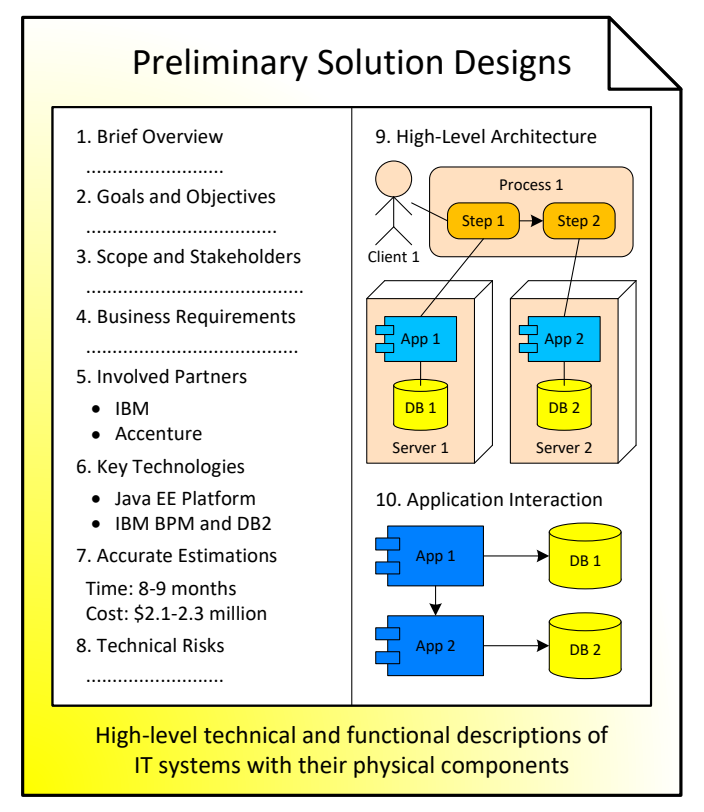
Lists of possible high-level implementation options for IT solutions with their pros and cons



Solution Overviews

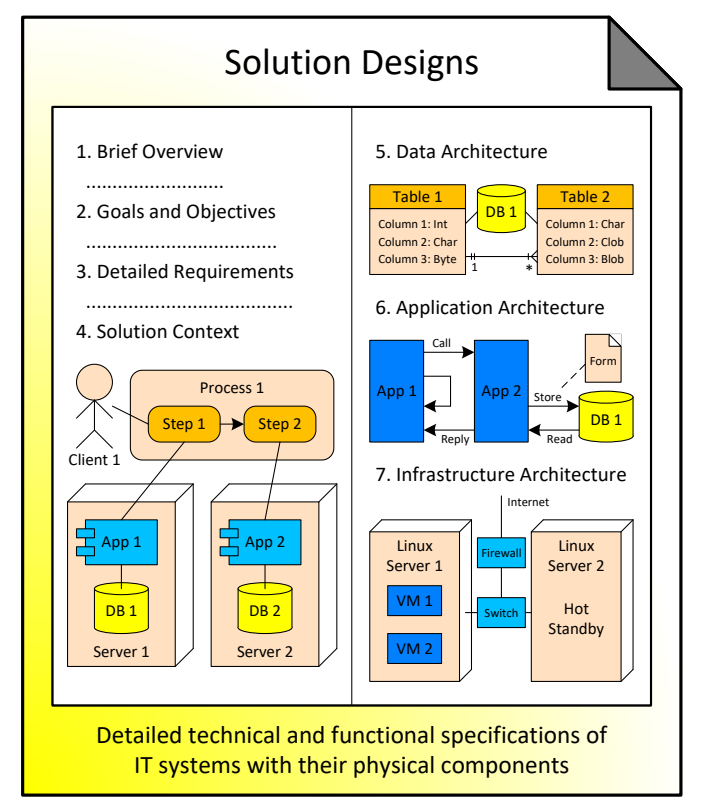
High-level descriptions of IT solutions with their logical components highlighting their business aspects

Solutions



Preliminary Solution Designs

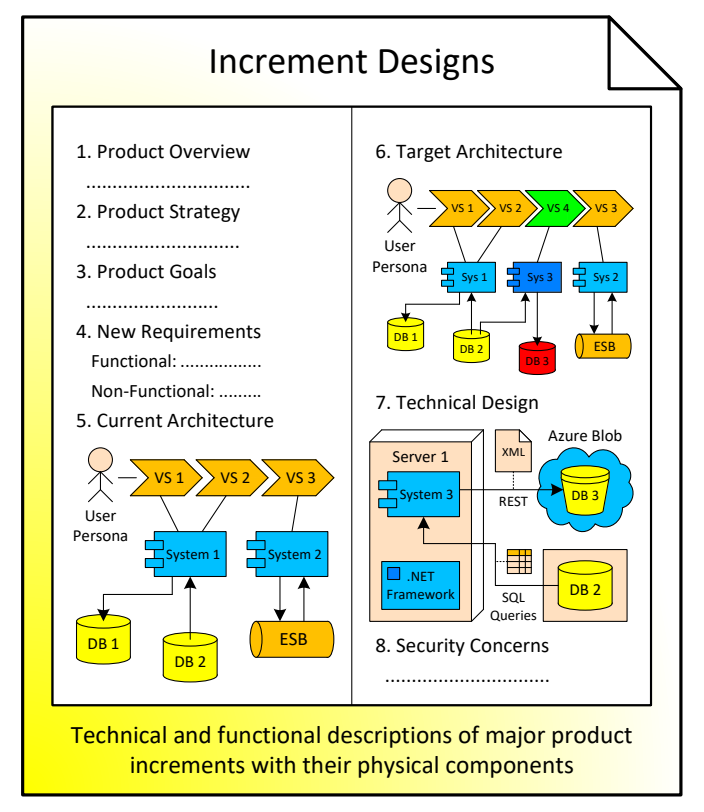
High-level technical and functional descriptions of IT systems with their physical components



Solution Designs

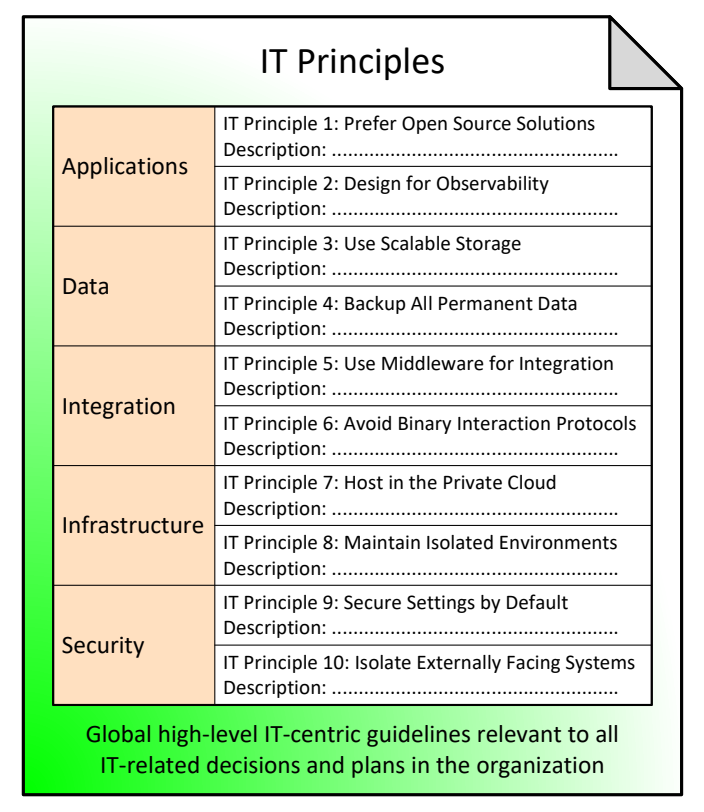
Detailed technical and functional specifications of IT systems with their physical components

Products



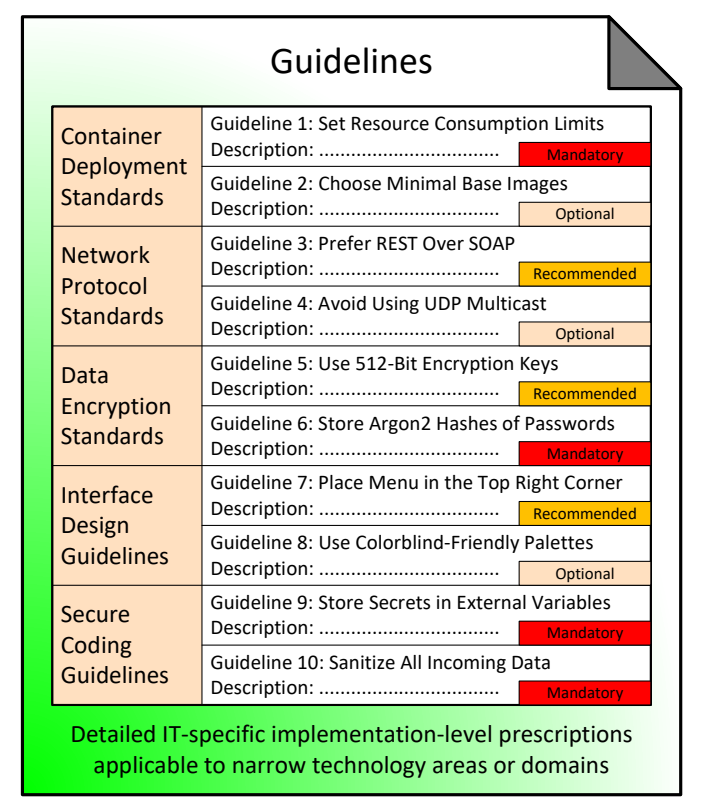
Increment Designs

Technical and functional descriptions of major product increments with their physical components


Applications
Data
Integration
Infrastructure
Security
IT Principle 1: Prefer Open Source Solutions
IT Principle 2: Design for Observability
IT Principle 3: Use Scalable Storage
IT Principle 4: Backup All Permanent Data
IT Principle 5: Use Middleware for Integration
IT Principle 6: Avoid Binary Interaction Protocols
IT Principle 7: Host in the Private Cloud
IT Principle 8: Maintain Isolated Environments
IT Principle 9: Secure Settings by Default
IT Principle 10: Isolate Externally Facing Systems

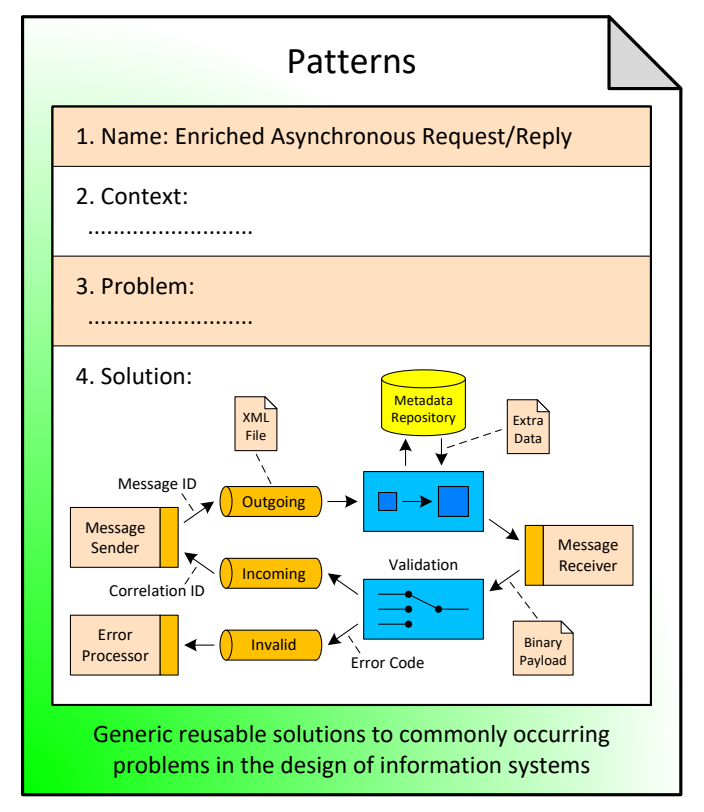
IT Principles

Global high-level IT-centric guidelines relevant to all IT-related decisions and plans in the organization


Container Deployment Standards
Network Protocol Standards
Data Encryption Standards
Interface Design Guidelines
Secure Coding Guidelines
Guideline 1: Set Resource Consumption Limits
Guideline 2: Choose Minimal Base Images
Guideline 3: Prefer REST Over SOAP
Guideline 4: Avoid Using UDP Multicast
Guideline 5: Use 512-Bit Encryption Keys
Guideline 6: Store Argon2 Hashes of Passwords
Guideline 7: Place Menu in the Top Right Corner
Guideline 8: Use Colorblind-Friendly Palettes
Guideline 9: Store Secrets in External Variables
Guideline 10: Sanitize All Incoming Data
Mandatory
Recommended
Optional

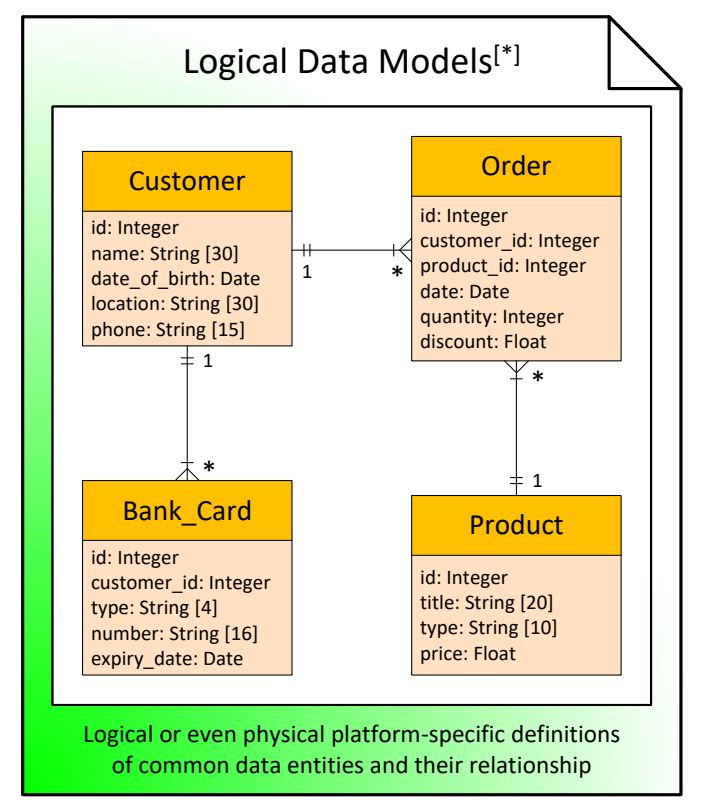
Guidelines

Detailed IT-specific implementation-level prescriptions applicable to narrow technology areas or domains



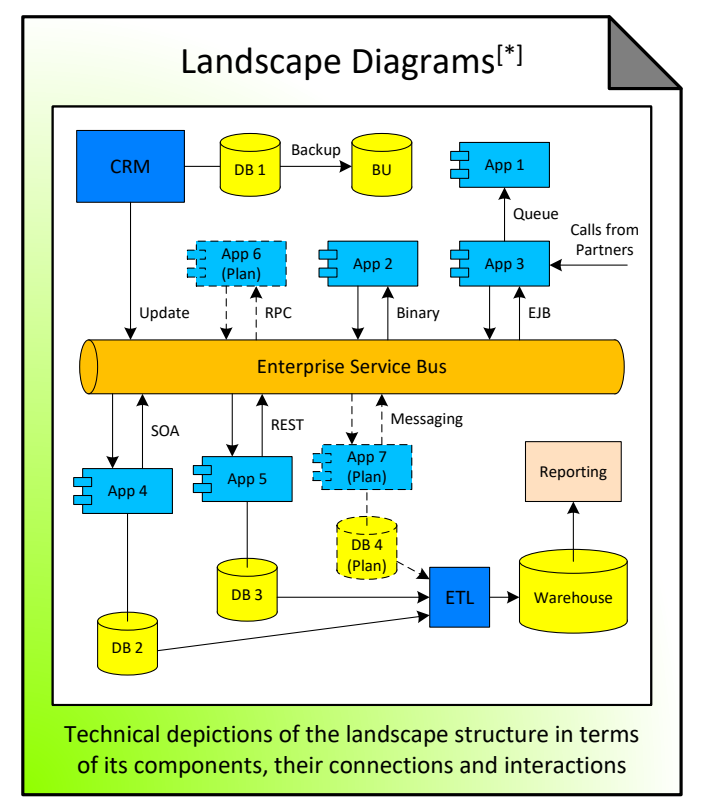
Patterns

Generic reusable solutions to commonly occurring problems in the design of information systems



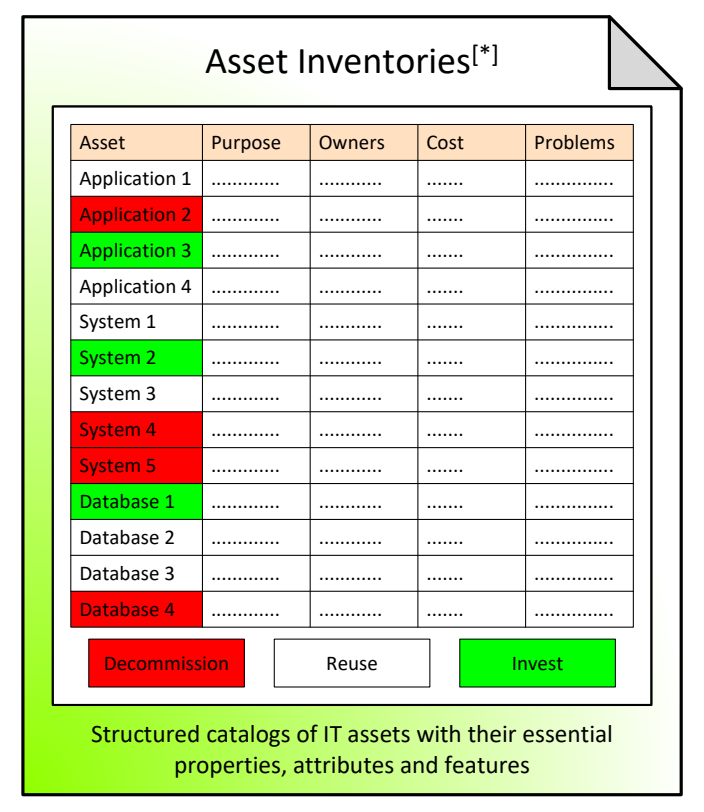
Logical Data Models[*]

Logical or even physical platform-specific definitions of common data entities and their relationship



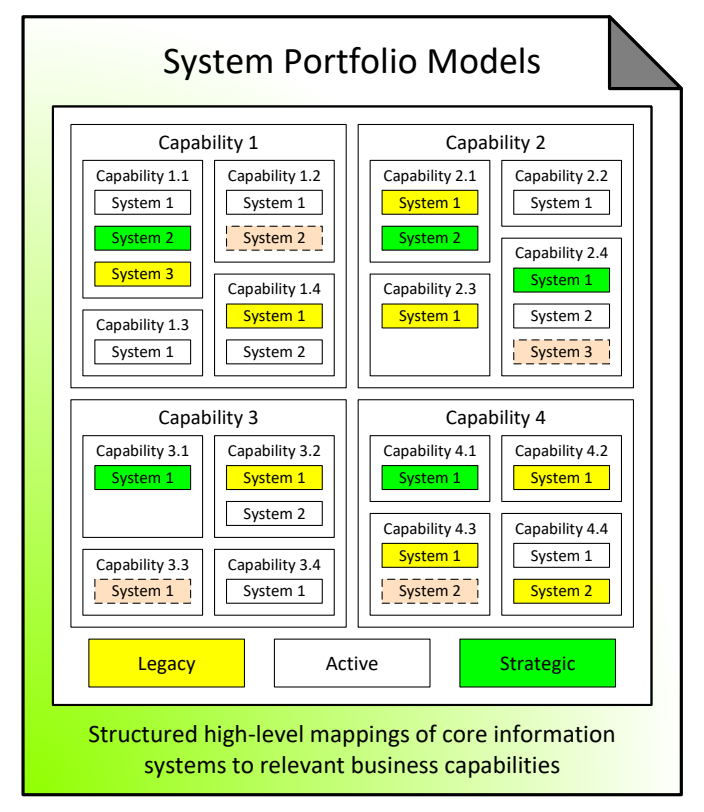
Landscape Diagrams[*]

Technical depictions of the landscape structure in terms of its components, their connections and interactions



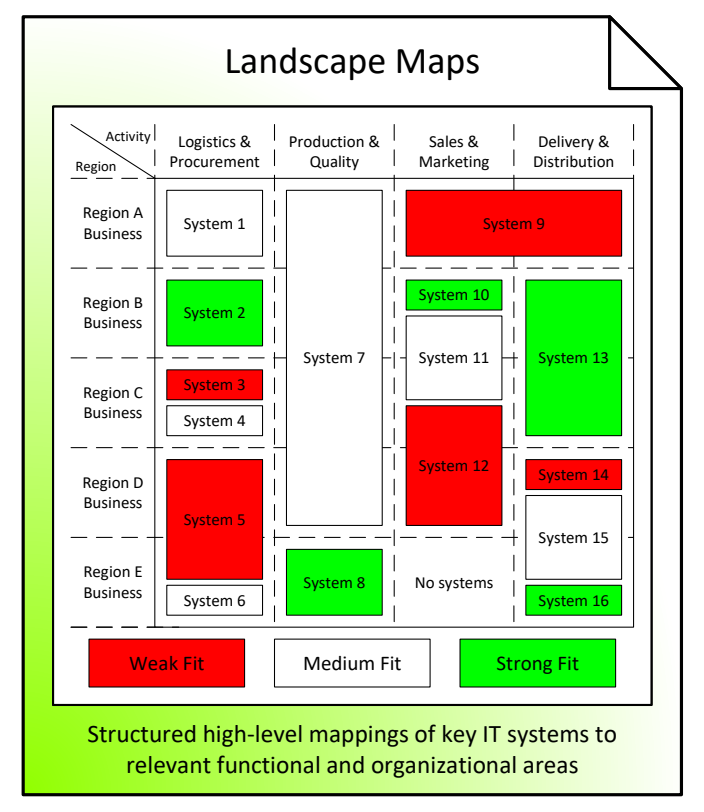
Asset Inventories[*]

Structured catalogs of IT assets with their essential properties, attributes and features



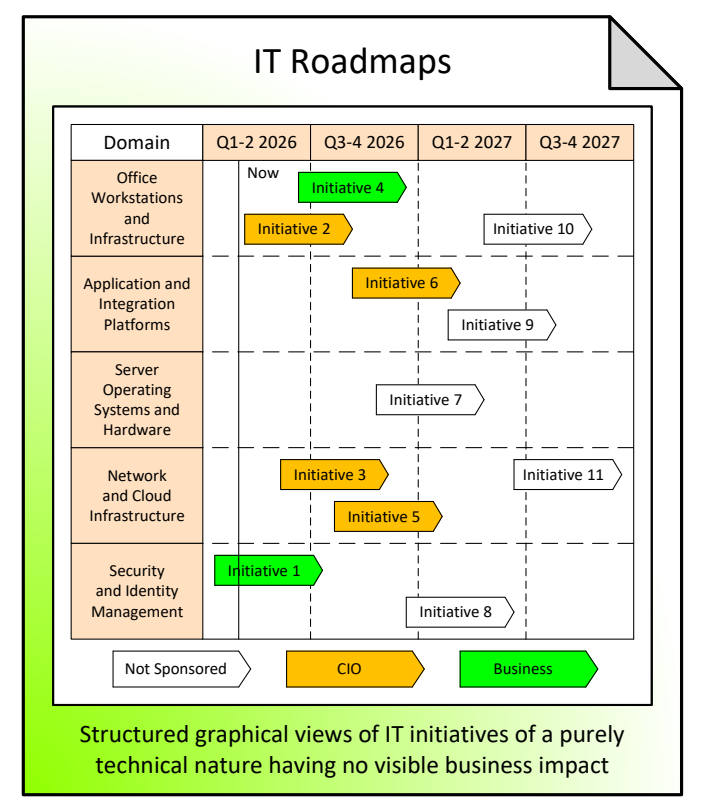
System Portfolio Models

Structured high-level mappings of core information systems to relevant business capabilities



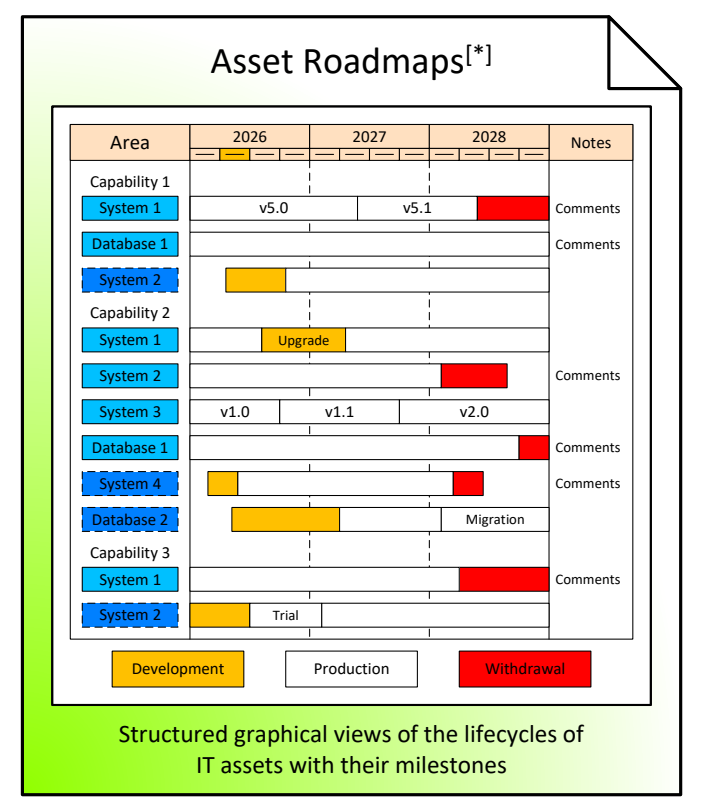
Landscape Maps

Structured high-level mappings of key IT systems to relevant functional and organizational areas



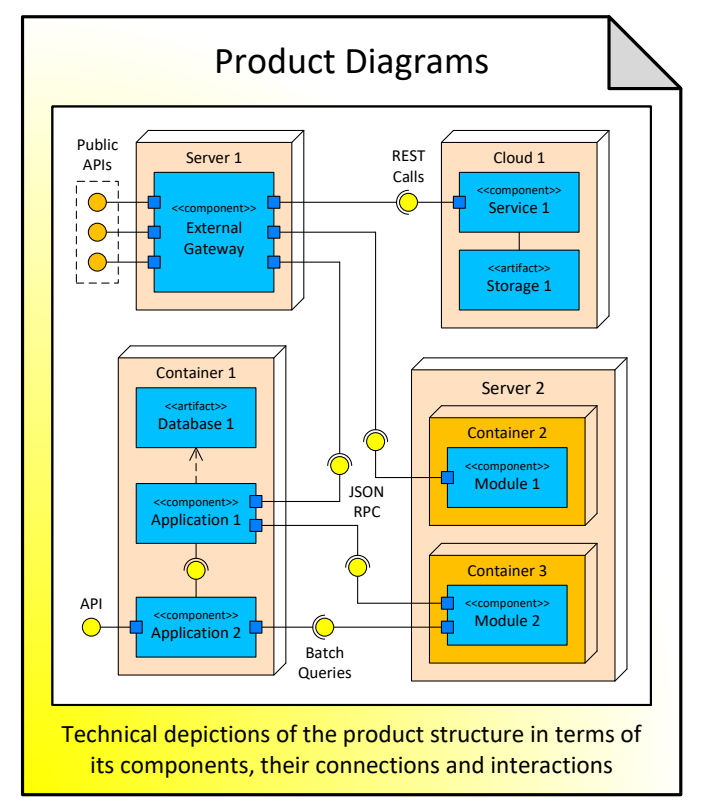
IT Roadmaps

Structured graphical views of IT initiatives of a purely technical nature having no visible business impact



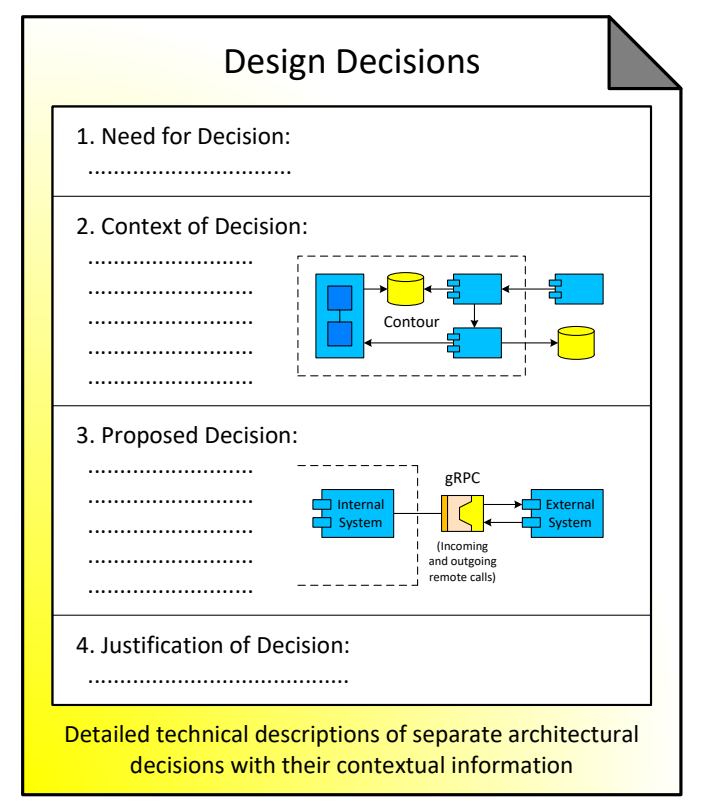
Asset Roadmaps[*]

Structured graphical views of the lifecycles of IT assets with their milestones



Product Diagrams

Technical depictions of the product structure in terms of its components, their connections and interactions



Design Decisions

Detailed technical descriptions of separate architectural decisions with their contextual information

Legend

- Popular Artifacts (Used in more than 60% of EA practices)
- Common Artifacts (Used in about 30–60% of EA practices)
- Uncommon Artifacts (Used in about 10–30% of EA practices)

Notes

Mature EA practices usually use pragmatic sets of 12–18 value-adding EA artifacts, or only about a half of all the presented artifacts

Templates demonstrate only the most typical content, structure and format of EA artifacts; they should be adapted, not copied mindlessly

[*] These EA artifacts are particularly often stored in specialized tool-based architectural repositories and extracted as views

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